Home Ready UK

Free printable checklist

Power cut

Most power cuts are short. A little planning keeps you safe, warm and informed.

Before

- [ ] Keep a torch and spare batteries where you can find them in the dark
- [ ] Keep a power bank charged
- [ ] Note your network operator and the number 105
- [ ] Know where your fuse box is
- [ ] If anyone relies on powered medical equipment, talk to the care team and join the Priority Services Register

During

- [ ] Call 105 to report it or get updates
- [ ] Check whether neighbours have power: if they do, check your fuse box
- [ ] Use torches, not candles
- [ ] Keep fridge and freezer doors shut
- [ ] Switch off appliances that could start up unattended, leaving one light on
- [ ] Never use a gas cooker, barbecue or generator indoors for heat

After

- [ ] Check food in the fridge and freezer; if in doubt, throw it out
- [ ] Reset clocks and timers
- [ ] Recharge the power bank and replace used batteries
- [ ] Check on neighbours who may need help

Kit list

- [ ] Torch
- [ ] Spare batteries
- [ ] Power bank (charged)
- [ ] FM radio (battery or wind-up)
- [ ] Blankets and warm layers
- [ ] Food that needs no cooking
- [ ] Bottled water

Sources: Power cut 105 (Energy Networks Association) (www.powercut105.com/); Priority Services Register (energy networks) (www.thepsr.co.uk/); GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Flooding

Flood warnings give you time to act. Sign up and make a plan now.

Before

- [ ] Check your flood risk and sign up for free flood warnings online at GOV.UK, or call Floodline on 0345 988 1188 (England, Scotland and Wales)
- [ ] Know how to turn off gas, electricity and water
- [ ] Keep a flood kit and important documents in waterproof bags
- [ ] Make a flood plan: where to move valuables and where to go
- [ ] Check your home insurance covers flooding

During

- [ ] Follow advice from the emergency services and Environment Agency
- [ ] Move people, pets and valuables upstairs or to safety
- [ ] Turn off gas, electricity and water if safe to do so
- [ ] Do not walk or drive through flood water: it can be deeper and faster than it looks and may be contaminated
- [ ] Call 999 if life is in danger

After

- [ ] Contact your insurer before throwing things away; take photos
- [ ] Wear gloves and wellies when cleaning up; wash hands well
- [ ] Do not switch on electrics until an electrician has checked them
- [ ] Check on neighbours

Kit list

- [ ] Waterproof bags for documents
- [ ] Torch and batteries
- [ ] Wellies and rubber gloves
- [ ] Hand sanitiser and wipes
- [ ] Medication
- [ ] Phone charger / power bank
- [ ] Flood plan and contact numbers

Sources: GOV.UK: Sign up for flood warnings (www.gov.uk/sign-up-for-flood-warnings); GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Storms and high winds

The Met Office issues yellow, amber and red weather warnings. Act early.

Before

- [ ] Check Met Office warnings when storms are forecast
- [ ] Secure or bring in garden furniture, bins and trampolines
- [ ] Charge phones and power banks
- [ ] Park away from trees and buildings if possible

During

- [ ] Stay indoors as much as you can
- [ ] Avoid travel unless necessary; follow travel updates
- [ ] Keep away from fallen power lines: call 105 and 999 if there is danger
- [ ] Do not walk along sea fronts or coastal paths

After

- [ ] Check your property for damage only when it is safe
- [ ] Report fallen trees on roads to your council
- [ ] Photograph damage for insurance
- [ ] Check on neighbours

Kit list

- [ ] Torch and batteries
- [ ] Power bank
- [ ] FM radio
- [ ] Food that needs no cooking
- [ ] Bottled water
- [ ] Warm layers

Sources: Met Office: Weather warnings (weather.metoffice.gov.uk/guides/warnings); Power cut 105 (Energy Networks Association) (www.powercut105.com/); GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Heatwave

Hot weather can affect anyone, especially older people, babies and people with health conditions.

Before

- [ ] Check Met Office forecasts and UKHSA heat-health alerts
- [ ] Know which room stays coolest
- [ ] Check your medicines' storage instructions
- [ ] Plan to check on people who may struggle in heat

During

- [ ] Keep out of the sun at the hottest time of day
- [ ] Close curtains on rooms that face the sun
- [ ] Drink plenty of fluids and avoid too much alcohol
- [ ] Never leave anyone, or pets, in a closed parked car
- [ ] Call 111 if you or someone else feels unwell, or 999 in an emergency

After

- [ ] Keep checking on older neighbours and relatives
- [ ] Restock water
- [ ] Note what worked for next time

Kit list

- [ ] Bottled water
- [ ] Fan
- [ ] Sun cream and hats
- [ ] Light, loose clothing
- [ ] Thermometer for the coolest room

Sources: NHS: Heatwave (www.nhs.uk/live-well/seasonal-health/heatwave-how-to-cope-in-hot-weather/); UKHSA: Weather-health alerts (www.gov.uk/guidance/weather-health-alerting-system); Met Office: Weather warnings (weather.metoffice.gov.uk/guides/warnings). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Severe cold and snow

Cold weather can affect health and homes. Prepare before winter.

Before

- [ ] Get your boiler serviced and know where your stop tap is
- [ ] Lag pipes to help stop them freezing
- [ ] Stock up on medicines and food in case it is hard to get out
- [ ] Check UKHSA cold-health alerts and Met Office warnings

During

- [ ] Heat the rooms you use most; NHS advice is at least 18°C if you can
- [ ] Wear several thin layers and have warm drinks
- [ ] Only travel if you need to
- [ ] If a pipe freezes, turn off the water at the stop tap

After

- [ ] Check on older neighbours
- [ ] Clear paths with care
- [ ] Check pipes for leaks as they thaw

Kit list

- [ ] Blankets and warm layers
- [ ] Hot water bottle
- [ ] Torch and batteries
- [ ] Grit or salt
- [ ] Food and water for 3 days

Sources: NHS: Keep warm, keep well (www.nhs.uk/live-well/seasonal-health/keep-warm-keep-well/); UKHSA: Weather-health alerts (www.gov.uk/guidance/weather-health-alerting-system); Met Office: Weather warnings (weather.metoffice.gov.uk/guides/warnings). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Staying warm without power

If the heating fails, simple, safe steps keep you warm.

Before

- [ ] Fit a carbon monoxide alarm
- [ ] Draught-proof before winter
- [ ] Keep blankets, sleeping bags and hot water bottles
- [ ] Join the Priority Services Register if you may need extra help

During

- [ ] Heat or use one room
- [ ] Layer up and use bedding
- [ ] Never use outdoor heaters, barbecues, camping stoves or a gas hob for heating indoors

After

- [ ] Check on vulnerable neighbours
- [ ] Restock and service your boiler

Kit list

- [ ] Blankets / sleeping bags
- [ ] Hot water bottles
- [ ] Hats, gloves, thick socks
- [ ] Draught excluder
- [ ] CO alarm
- [ ] Torch

Sources: UKHSA: Keeping warm and well (www.gov.uk/government/publications/keeping-warm-and-well-staying-safe-in-cold-weather); NHS: Keep warm, keep well (www.nhs.uk/live-well/seasonal-health/keep-warm-keep-well/); GOV.UK Fire Kills; HSE: Carbon monoxide (www.hse.gov.uk/gas/domestic/co.htm). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Water supply outage

If the taps stop, your water company will give updates and arrange alternative supplies.

Before

- [ ] Store bottled water: 3 litres per person per day for drinking, for 3 days
- [ ] Know your water company and its number
- [ ] Join your water company's Priority Services Register if you need extra help
- [ ] Know where your stop tap is

During

- [ ] Check your water company's website or social media for updates
- [ ] Save bottled water for drinking, cooking and baby formula
- [ ] Use hand sanitiser and wipes to save water
- [ ] Check on neighbours who may struggle to collect water

After

- [ ] Run the cold kitchen tap until the water runs clear
- [ ] Follow any 'boil water' advice from your water company
- [ ] Replace the bottled water you used

Kit list

- [ ] Bottled water
- [ ] Hand sanitiser
- [ ] Wet wipes
- [ ] Paper plates and cups
- [ ] Bin bags

Sources: Water UK: Find your supplier (www.water.org.uk/customers/find-your-supplier); Ofwat: Supply interruptions (www.ofwat.gov.uk/households/supply-and-standards/supply-interruptions/); GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Cyber attack, card payments and internet down

Card payments, cash machines or the internet can sometimes be disrupted. A little cash and paper notes help.

Before

- [ ] Keep some cash (a mix of coins and notes)
- [ ] Write important numbers on paper
- [ ] Keep a charged power bank and an FM radio
- [ ] Use strong passwords and two-step verification; keep devices updated

During

- [ ] Use cash for essentials
- [ ] Get updates from FM radio and official channels
- [ ] Be wary of scam messages that mention the outage
- [ ] Do not share passwords or codes with anyone who contacts you

After

- [ ] Check bank statements for anything unusual
- [ ] Report fraud to your bank and to Action Fraud
- [ ] Replace the cash you used

Kit list

- [ ] Cash (coins and notes)
- [ ] Paper list of numbers
- [ ] Power bank
- [ ] FM radio
- [ ] Notebook and pen

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/); NCSC: Cyber Aware (www.ncsc.gov.uk/cyberaware); Action Fraud (www.actionfraud.police.uk/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Illness or pandemic at home

Being prepared makes it easier to look after yourself and others while staying at home.

Before

- [ ] Keep a basic medicine cabinet and first aid items
- [ ] Keep a list of everyone's medicines
- [ ] Arrange who could shop or collect prescriptions for you
- [ ] Keep cleaning products and tissues

During

- [ ] Follow NHS and UKHSA advice
- [ ] Wash hands often; clean surfaces that people touch
- [ ] Use NHS 111 online or call 111 for advice; 999 in an emergency
- [ ] Ask friends or neighbours to leave shopping at the door

After

- [ ] Wash bedding and towels
- [ ] Restock medicines and supplies
- [ ] Thank your helpers and update your plan

Kit list

- [ ] Thermometer
- [ ] Tissues
- [ ] Hand soap and sanitiser
- [ ] Cleaning products
- [ ] Food for 3 days
- [ ] First aid items

Sources: NHS 111 (111.nhs.uk/); UKHSA (www.gov.uk/government/organisations/uk-health-security-agency); NHS: How pharmacies can help (www.nhs.uk/nhs-services/pharmacies/how-pharmacies-can-help/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

Home Ready UK

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Home fire safety and escape plan

Working smoke alarms and a practised escape plan save lives.

Before

- [ ] Fit smoke alarms on every level and test them monthly
- [ ] Fit a carbon monoxide alarm in rooms with a fuel-burning appliance
- [ ] Plan and practise two ways out; keep exits clear
- [ ] Keep door and window keys where everyone can find them
- [ ] Ask your fire and rescue service about a free Home Fire Safety Check

During

- [ ] Get out, stay out, call 999
- [ ] Close doors behind you
- [ ] If there is smoke, keep low
- [ ] Never go back in

After

- [ ] Do not re-enter until the fire service says it is safe
- [ ] Contact your insurer
- [ ] Replace alarms if damaged

Kit list

- [ ] Smoke alarms
- [ ] Carbon monoxide alarm
- [ ] Fire blanket in the kitchen
- [ ] Torch by the bed
- [ ] Keys in a known place

Sources: GOV.UK Fire Kills (www.gov.uk/firekills); NHS: Carbon monoxide poisoning (www.nhs.uk/conditions/carbon-monoxide-poisoning/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Evacuation and grab bag

Sometimes you may be asked to leave home quickly. A grab bag helps.

Before

- [ ] Pack a grab bag for each person or the household
- [ ] Agree a meeting point and a contact outside the area
- [ ] Know how you would take pets
- [ ] Keep car fuel or charge topped up if you can

During

- [ ] Follow instructions from the emergency services
- [ ] Take your grab bag, medicines and phone
- [ ] Turn off gas, electricity and water if told to and safe
- [ ] Lock doors and windows
- [ ] Tell your contact where you are going

After

- [ ] Only return when told it is safe
- [ ] Check your home for damage
- [ ] Restock the grab bag

Kit list

- [ ] Copies of documents
- [ ] Medicines and list
- [ ] Cash
- [ ] Phone and charger / power bank
- [ ] Torch
- [ ] Water and snacks
- [ ] Warm layers
- [ ] Toiletries
- [ ] Pet supplies

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/); British Red Cross: Prepare an emergency kit (www.redcross.org.uk/get-help/prepare-for-emergencies/prepare-an-emergency-kit). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Travel disruption and car kit

Snow, storms and floods can leave you stuck on the road.

Before

- [ ] Check the forecast and travel updates before you go
- [ ] Keep a car kit in the boot
- [ ] Keep your fuel tank or battery reasonably full in winter

During

- [ ] If stuck, stay with your vehicle unless it is unsafe
- [ ] Run the engine for heat only if the exhaust is clear of snow
- [ ] Call your breakdown provider, or 999 in an emergency

After

- [ ] Restock the car kit
- [ ] Note what you needed but did not have

Kit list

- [ ] Ice scraper and de-icer
- [ ] Torch
- [ ] Blanket and warm clothes
- [ ] Phone charger
- [ ] Water and snacks
- [ ] First aid kit
- [ ] Shovel (winter)
- [ ] Hi-vis vest

Sources: Met Office: UK warnings (weather.metoffice.gov.uk/warnings-and-advice/uk-warnings); National Highways: Travel updates (www.nationalhighways.co.uk/travel-updates/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Pets

Pets need a plan too.

Before

- [ ] Keep 3 days of pet food and bottled water
- [ ] Keep vet details and microchip numbers
- [ ] Have a carrier and lead ready
- [ ] Agree who could look after pets if you cannot

During

- [ ] Keep pets indoors in storms and extreme weather
- [ ] Take pets with you if you leave home

After

- [ ] Check pets for injury or stress
- [ ] Restock food

Kit list

- [ ] Pet food
- [ ] Bottled water and bowl
- [ ] Lead / carrier
- [ ] Medicines
- [ ] Vet details
- [ ] Photo of your pet

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/); RSPCA: Floods and pets (www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/seasonal/floods). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Babies and children

A few extra items make a big difference for young children.

Before

- [ ] Keep ready-to-feed formula if you use formula (you may not be able to boil water)
- [ ] Keep nappies and wipes for 3 days
- [ ] Pack comfort items and simple games
- [ ] Agree school pick-up plans

During

- [ ] Keep children warm and fed
- [ ] Explain calmly what is happening
- [ ] Follow official advice on making up feeds

After

- [ ] Restock baby items
- [ ] Talk to children about what happened

Kit list

- [ ] Ready-to-feed formula
- [ ] Nappies and wipes
- [ ] Spare clothes
- [ ] Comfort toy
- [ ] Books and games
- [ ] Children's medicines

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/); NHS: Making up baby formula (www.nhs.uk/baby/breastfeeding-and-bottle-feeding/bottle-feeding/making-up-baby-formula/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Older people

Checking in and simple plans help older people stay safe.

Before

- [ ] Join the Priority Services Register for energy and water
- [ ] Keep a list of medicines and contacts
- [ ] Arrange regular check-ins with family or neighbours

During

- [ ] Keep warm (or cool in heat)
- [ ] Have food and drinks within reach
- [ ] Call 111 for advice or 999 in an emergency

After

- [ ] Check in again
- [ ] Update the plan

Kit list

- [ ] Torch
- [ ] Blankets
- [ ] Medicines
- [ ] Glasses and hearing aid batteries
- [ ] Paper list of numbers

Sources: Priority Services Register (energy networks) (www.thepsr.co.uk/); Age UK: Health and wellbeing (www.ageuk.org.uk/information-advice/health-wellbeing/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Carers and people with disabilities

Plan for equipment, care and communication needs.

Before

- [ ] Register with your energy supplier and network operator's Priority Services Register
- [ ] Register with your water company's register too
- [ ] Talk to the care team about a plan for equipment that needs power or water
- [ ] Make a back-up plan if the carer cannot attend
- [ ] If you cannot make voice calls, register for emergencySMS by texting 'register' to 999

During

- [ ] Call 105 for power cuts; tell them about medical equipment
- [ ] Use the back-up care plan
- [ ] Use Relay UK or emergencySMS if needed

After

- [ ] Review what worked
- [ ] Update your registrations

Kit list

- [ ] Spare equipment batteries
- [ ] Power bank
- [ ] Medicines
- [ ] Care plan
- [ ] Communication aids

Sources: Priority Services Register (energy networks) (www.thepsr.co.uk/); Water UK: Find your supplier (www.water.org.uk/customers/find-your-supplier); Relay UK: emergencySMS (www.relayuk.bt.com/how-to-use-relay-uk/contact-999-using-relay-uk.html). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Medicines management

Keep track of medicines so you are not caught short.

Before

- [ ] Keep a written list of everyone's medicines and doses
- [ ] Order repeat prescriptions in good time
- [ ] Check storage instructions and expiry dates
- [ ] Ask your pharmacist if you are unsure

During

- [ ] Keep medicines with you if you leave home
- [ ] Ask a pharmacist for help if you run short
- [ ] Call 111 for advice

After

- [ ] Return out-of-date medicines to a pharmacy
- [ ] Update the list

Kit list

- [ ] Medicines list
- [ ] Repeat prescription slips
- [ ] Pharmacy number
- [ ] Cool bag if needed

Sources: NHS: How pharmacies can help (www.nhs.uk/nhs-services/pharmacies/how-pharmacies-can-help/); NHS 111 (111.nhs.uk/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Important documents and money

Paper copies and some cash help when systems are down.

Before

- [ ] Keep copies of ID and key documents together
- [ ] Keep some cash (coins and notes)
- [ ] Write down bank, insurer and utility numbers

During

- [ ] Take documents and cash if you leave
- [ ] Use cash if card payments fail

After

- [ ] Replace cash used
- [ ] Update copies when things change

Kit list

- [ ] Waterproof folder
- [ ] Copies of ID
- [ ] Insurance details
- [ ] Cash
- [ ] Numbers list

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independen t and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Food and water storage and rotation

Build up gradually on your normal shop, store it well and use the oldest first.

Before

- [ ] Store 3 days of food you usually eat, and 3 litres of water per person per day
- [ ] Note dates on the rotation log
- [ ] Plan for allergies, special diets, babies and pets

During

- [ ] Eat fridge food first, then freezer, then cupboard
- [ ] Keep fridge and freezer doors shut
- [ ] Save bottled water for drinking and baby feeds

After

- [ ] If in doubt about chilled food, throw it out
- [ ] Replace what you used
- [ ] Check dates every 6 months

Kit list

- [ ] Bottled water
- [ ] Tins and long-life food
- [ ] Manual tin opener
- [ ] UHT milk
- [ ] Snacks
- [ ] Allergy-safe foods
- [ ] Baby and pet food

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/); Food Standards Agency: Best before and use-by dates (www.food.gov.uk/safety-hygiene/best-before-and-use-by-dates); NHS: Carbon monoxide poisoning (www.nhs.uk/conditions/carbon-monoxide-poisoning/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Staying informed

In an outage, official information still gets through.

Before

- [ ] Keep an FM radio (battery or wind-up) and note station frequencies
- [ ] Know that GOV.UK may send Emergency Alerts to mobile phones
- [ ] Follow your council, water company and network operator

During

- [ ] Listen to local radio
- [ ] Check official channels, not rumours
- [ ] Save phone battery

After

- [ ] Share accurate information with neighbours

Kit list

- [ ] FM radio
- [ ] Spare batteries
- [ ] Power bank
- [ ] List of frequencies

Sources: GOV.UK: Emergency Alerts (www.gov.uk/alerts); GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.

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Checking on neighbours and community

Neighbours are often the first help to arrive.

Before

- [ ] Swap numbers with neighbours
- [ ] Know who might need extra help
- [ ] Find out about local community groups

During

- [ ] Check on others if safe
- [ ] Share what you can

After

- [ ] Talk about what helped

Kit list

- [ ] Spare torch
- [ ] Extra water
- [ ] Numbers list

Sources: GOV.UK Be Ready (beready.campaign.gov.uk/be-ready-for-emergencies/). Home Ready UK is independent and not part of the UK Government. Emergency: 999. Power cut: 105. NHS: 111.